

Linux Commands Cheat Sheet for Interviews

Basic Commands

- pwd - Print working directory
- ls - List files and directories
- cd - Change directory
- mkdir - Create a directory
- touch - Create a new file
- cat - View file contents
- echo - Display text or variables

File Management

- cp - Copy files or directories
- mv - Move or rename files
- rm - Remove files or directories
- find - Search files in directory
- du - Show directory size
- df - Show disk usage

User & Permission Management

- useradd - Add new user
- passwd - Change user password
- chown - Change file owner
- chmod - Change file permissions
- groups - Show groups for a user

System & Process Monitoring

- ps aux - Show running processes
- top - Real-time process monitoring
- kill - Terminate a process
- free - Show memory usage
- uptime - Show system uptime

Networking

- ping - Test network connection
- ip a - Show IP addresses
- ss -tulnp - Show open ports
- curl - Fetch data from a URL
- scp - Secure copy files between systems
- ssh - Connect to a remote server

Service Management

- systemctl start <service> - Start a service
- systemctl stop <service> - Stop a service
- systemctl restart <service> - Restart service
- systemctl enable <service> - Enable service on boot
- systemctl status <service> - Show service status

Archiving & Compression

- tar -cvf file.tar dir/ - Create tar archive
- tar -xvf file.tar - Extract tar archive
- gzip file - Compress file
- gunzip file.gz - Decompress file